

AFK Camera

Installation & Quick Start Manual

X-Plane 12

FlyWithLua NG+ based cinematic AFK camera system

What is AFK Camera?

AFK Camera waits for pilot inactivity and then selects a cinematic director based on the current view. In the cockpit it animates the pilot head while leaving the normal X-Plane camera active. In supported external views it runs authored cinematic aircraft shots.

Requirements

Component	Requirement
Simulator	X-Plane 12
Scripting	FlyWithLua NG+ with floating-window / ImGui support
Platform	Windows
Optional	Better Mouse Yoke if you use mouse-yoke flying

Development target: FlyWithLua NG+ 2.8.16. The current script also requires the Windows user32 API, so this version is intended for Windows installations.

1. Install FlyWithLua

AFK Camera runs as a FlyWithLua script. If FlyWithLua is already working in your X-Plane installation, skip to the next section.

1

Install FlyWithLua

Install the X-Plane 12 version of FlyWithLua. On Windows, the plugin belongs in the X-Plane Resources/plugins folder.

Expected location:

X-Plane 12/Resources/plugins/FlyWithLua/

Official project: <https://github.com/X-Friese/FlyWithLua>

2. Install AFK Camera

2

Locate the Scripts folder

Open the FlyWithLua folder and locate the Scripts directory.

X-Plane 12/Resources/plugins/FlyWithLua/Scripts/

3

Copy the Lua script

Copy the file `AFK_Camera.lua` directly into the Scripts folder. Do not put it inside another subfolder.

X-Plane 12/Resources/plugins/FlyWithLua/Scripts/AFK_Camera.lua

Windows users

The current AFK Camera script uses the Windows user32 API for mouse input detection. This build should therefore be installed on Windows.

3. First Launch

4

Start X-Plane 12

Launch X-Plane 12 and load an aircraft. For the first installation, a full restart is recommended.

5

Check FlyWithLua

Open the X-Plane Plugins menu and confirm that FlyWithLua is present.

6

Open AFK Camera Settings

Navigate to the FlyWithLua macro list and open the AFK Camera settings window.

Plugins -> FlyWithLua -> FlyWithLua Macros -> AFK Camera: Open Settings

7

Save your configuration

Adjust the timer and input options, then press **Save Settings**.

AFKCamera_settings.ini

The settings file is automatically created beside the Lua script. You normally do not need to edit it manually.

4. Test the AFK system

A good first test is to use a 10-30 second timeout, keep the debug HUD visible, and remain hands-off long enough for the timer to expire.

Test	Expected result
Idle in cockpit	Cockpit pilot-head animation begins after the timeout.
Idle in an external supported view	External cinematic shots begin.
Move the controls	AFK mode exits and normal control resumes.
Change view during AFK	AFK mode exits and camera ownership returns to X-Plane.

5. Configure AFK Camera

The settings window provides the main user controls. Changes are live; press Save Settings to persist them.

Setting	Default	What it controls
Enable AFK Camera	On	Enables or disables AFK behavior.
AFK Timer	30 s	Seconds of inactivity before AFK mode begins. Range: 3-300 s.
Mouse movement ends AFK	On	Plain cursor movement wakes the simulator when enabled.
Joystick dead zone	1.0%	Ignores tiny frame-to-frame axis changes caused by hardware jitter.
Show Debug HUD	On	Shows status, idle time, shot, view and camera ownership while testing.

Restore Defaults

The Restore Defaults button resets all user settings to the developer defaults defined near the top of the Lua file, then saves the restored values to AFKCamera_settings.ini.

Current developer defaults

```
Enabled: true
AFK timeout: 30 seconds
Debug HUD: visible
Mouse movement wake-up: enabled
Joystick dead zone: 1.0%
```

6. Understand the camera modes

Cockpit: AFK Camera does not take XPLM camera ownership. It animates X-Plane's pilot-head view values, so the normal cockpit camera remains active.

External: supported external views use the cinematic director. Shot paths are randomized without immediate repetition and adapt their distance to aircraft size.

7. Better Mouse Yoke

Better Mouse Yoke is optional. AFK Camera includes a dedicated detector for its yoke output so mouse-yoke flying can wake AFK mode just like a physical controller.

Important

AFK Camera detects Better Mouse Yoke activity; it does not enable, disable or configure Better Mouse Yoke.

If you already use Better Mouse Yoke, leave it installed normally and test that moving the yoke exits AFK mode.

Better Mouse Yoke project: <https://github.com/smiley22/XPPlugins>

8. Useful commands

Command / menu item	Purpose
AFK Camera: Open Settings	Opens the settings window from FlyWithLua Macros.
AFKCamera/settings_toggle	Opens/closes the settings window. Useful for assigning a hardware button.
AFKDirector/debug_hud_toggle	Toggles the debug HUD.

9. Updating the script

8

Back up your settings

Keep **AFKCamera_settings.ini** if you want to preserve your personal configuration.

9

Replace the Lua script

Replace the existing **AFK_Camera.lua** with the new version.

10

Restart or reload

Restart X-Plane for the cleanest update. FlyWithLua can also reload its Lua scripts from its Plugins menu.

Do not delete your settings file unless you want to reset saved preferences.

The Lua script will recreate the settings file when settings are saved.

10. Troubleshooting

AFK Camera does not load

Confirm FlyWithLua is installed and `AFK_Camera.lua` is directly inside FlyWithLua/Scripts. Check FlyWithLua's log for script errors.

Settings window does not open

The script requires FlyWithLua floating-window / ImGui support. If the script reports that floating windows are unsupported, use a compatible FlyWithLua NG+ build.

AFK starts but the cockpit does not animate

Make sure the active X-Plane view is a cockpit view. External and other supported camera views use the external cinematic director.

AFK wakes constantly from a joystick

Increase the joystick dead zone gradually until idle hardware jitter is ignored. The settings window reports the largest recent axis change.

Better Mouse Yoke does not wake AFK

Verify Better Mouse Yoke is active and actually changing the aircraft yoke. AFK Camera only detects the plugin's output.

Settings do not persist

Press Save Settings and confirm `AFKCamera_settings.ini` is being created beside `AFK_Camera.lua`. Check that the FlyWithLua Scripts folder is writable.

11. Recommended first configuration

For a simple first flight, keep the current defaults: AFK enabled, 30-second timer, debug HUD enabled, mouse movement wake-up enabled, and a 1.0% joystick dead zone. Once everything is confirmed working, hide the debug HUD and tune the timeout and dead zone to your preference.

You are ready to fly

Once the script is loaded and the settings window saves successfully, AFK Camera requires no additional in-simulator setup. Fly normally, stop interacting, and let the cinematic director take over when the timer expires.